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One of the more popular statistics known to science nerds is that the known universe is 99.999999999999999999999999% empty space. Bethesda's latest game, Starfield, goes out of its way to reinforce this. The game, marketed by the developer as being '25 years in the making' is undoubtedly massive. If its 125-ish gigabyte install size didn't make that apparent, then you would probably notice the scale of Starfield over the ~20-160 hours of gameplay (source: HowLongToBeat) that the game has in store for you.

Personally, it was after an hour and a half of gameplay that I shut it down and started scouring the modding community in an effort to make the gameplay less tedious. Another six hours later, I was torn between appreciating the work done by the

modders and the agony of what can only be described as painstakingly lazy storytelling in the guise of something revolutionary. At the nine-and-a-half-hour mark, I promptly uninstalled the game and moved on to more worthy pursuits. Like writing this review to convince you to put your ₹4,999 (or, God forbid, ₹6,699) into the stock market or something.

What? Just... What?

There's something about Starfield that bothered me from the get-go. I'm not a huge AAA gamer, so unlike some other players out there, I don't find myself as jaded by high-end graphics, hyper-realism and detail. I found both Shredder's Revenge and Baldur's Gate 3 enjoyable when I played them.

For the purpose of this game, the PtB (Powers that Be) procured a way more powerful AMD 7800 XT to get the complete experience. I'd installed

the game on an SSD (the Starfield page says this is a requirement) and my rig was powered by an i5-12600K (okay, maybe not a top-of-the-line processor, but pretty solid) and 32GB of RAM. Essentially, within recommended requirements and well above the average when compared to what most people play on, as per Steam's latest Hardware and Software survey.

Despite this, I still found the look and feel of Starfield a lot more dated than some of the newer games of the same calibre. Maybe it's the flat, dull looks of the characters as they speak. Maybe it's the fact that every base looks like a facsimile of the other 30 you've visited. Maybe it's the fact that when one hovers over a fern, the game informs you that the plant is called a 'succulent' (Mirriam-Webster defines 'succulent' as 'having fleshy tissues that conserve moisture'. Why is that the name of a